

Monday, June 8, 2026

1:00 p.m. – General Discussion

Commissioners Ron A. Smith, Chair; Colene M. Martin, Vice-Chair; Gary L. Richardson; Nikole Guzman, Recorder

Chair Ron Smith called the meeting to order at 1:00 p.m.

1. Declaration of Potential Conflicts of Interest

All Commissioners reviewed today's agenda, and it was determined that there are no conflicts of interest.

2. Southern Oregon Sanitation Franchise Sale

Chair Smith opened discussion regarding the proposed sale of Southern Oregon Sanitation (SOS) to Waste Connections. Smith stated for the record that the Board of Commissioners had no prior knowledge of the proposed transaction before the June 8, 2026 meeting and likewise had no knowledge of the transaction at the time recent rate adjustments associated with the Kirby Transfer Station were considered.

Trent Carpenter, representing Southern Oregon Sanitation, informed the Board that the Carpenter family had decided to sell the company after approximately eighty years of operation. Carpenter explained that the decision was based on a variety of family and business considerations and that discussions with Waste Connections began after the family determined it was time to transition ownership. Carpenter reported that Waste Connections had agreed to retain local management and staff and that customers should experience no interruption in service. Carpenter stated that collection schedules, customer service operations, company branding, and franchise obligations would remain unchanged following the anticipated August 1, 2026 closing date.

Brian White, Division Vice President for Waste Connections in Oregon, introduced himself and provided an overview of Waste Connections' operations throughout Oregon. White explained that the company intends to maintain the local operating structure currently utilized by Southern Oregon Sanitation and emphasized that customer service functions and day-to-day operational decisions would continue to be handled locally. White stated that the acquisition would not alter the existing franchise agreements or rate-setting processes and that any future rate requests would continue to be reviewed through the same regulatory and public processes currently in place.

Commissioners discussed the potential impact of the transaction on ratepayers, franchise administration, and solid waste operations within Josephine County. Carpenter explained that franchise agreements governing solid waste collection services establish allowable profit ranges and require annual financial reporting and review. Carpenter and White indicated that any future rate adjustments would remain subject to existing franchise requirements, review by the Southern Oregon Sanitation Agency, and approval by the appropriate governing bodies. Both representatives stated that the transaction itself would not result in automatic rate increases and that all existing contractual obligations would remain in effect following the sale.

Discussion also occurred regarding potential future revisions to local franchise agreements. Carpenter noted that local governments have expressed interest in updating and standardizing portions of the franchise agreements to remove outdated references, improve consistency among jurisdictions, and provide additional clarification regarding franchise enforcement and exemptions. Commissioners discussed concerns related to illegal dumping, cleanup efforts within rural areas of the County, and

opportunities to improve coordination between solid waste providers and local governments. Carpenter acknowledged those concerns and indicated that additional discussions regarding franchise modernization and enforcement could occur in the future.

Commissioners further discussed ownership of the Dry Creek Landfill by Waste Connections and asked whether the acquisition could affect disposal costs or franchise rates. White explained that Southern Oregon Sanitation would continue operating under existing disposal agreements and that rates charged under those agreements would remain subject to contractual provisions and regulatory oversight. Carpenter noted that Southern Oregon Sanitation currently operates under a long-term disposal agreement and that landfill pricing remains subject to review by the governing entities responsible for oversight.

The Board discussed the due diligence process associated with the transfer of franchise interests and reviewed provisions contained within the franchise agreements addressing financial capability, operational qualifications, and transfer requirements. White described Waste Connections' operations throughout Oregon and offered to provide references from other jurisdictions served by the company. Commissioners expressed appreciation for the information provided and indicated they would continue reviewing the transaction as it proceeds through the formal approval process.

Carpenter stated that the transaction would involve the transfer of ownership of Southern Oregon Sanitation and related assets while maintaining existing operations, employees, and franchise obligations. White reiterated Waste Connections' commitment to maintaining local operations and community involvement following completion of the transaction. Commissioners thanked Southern Oregon Sanitation and Waste Connections representatives for attending the meeting and providing information regarding the proposed sale.

3. Other

4. Additional Subject Matters from Commissioners/Announcements

The meeting adjourned at 1:31 p.m.